



NCBA Bank Limited

Merchandise Hub Management Process
Process Definition Document

VERSION: 1.0.0

1 Document review and approval

1.1 Revision history

Version	Author	Date	Department	Role	Comments
1.0.0	Wilson Wandu	13/02/2026	BPM	Business Process Architect	Initial Draft

1.2 Contributors - Process Owners

Name	Department	Responsibility
Abigael Opondo	Marketing Communications & Citizenship	Merchandise Process SME
Charles Ndirangu	Marketing Communications & Citizenship	Merchandise Governance

1.3 Document Review and Approval

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Prepared By:			
Wilson Wandu	Business Process Architect		
Reviewed By:			
Abigael Opondo	Assistant Brand Manager		
Charles Ndirangu	Senior Brand Manager		
Jacquie Muhati	Deputy Director, Group Head of Brands		
Lillian Muchiri	Lead, Business Process Architect		
Salesa Ali	Lead, RPA & Power Apps		
Approved By:			
Nelly Wainaina	Group Director Marketing Communications		
Patrick Muchoki	Head, Business Process Management		

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3 Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Description
MCC	Marketing, Communications & Citizenship
BU	Business Unit
BI	Business Intelligence

4 Introduction

4.1 Background

The **Merchandise Hub System** is a centralized digital platform designed to streamline the process of requesting and managing merchandise for customer engagement activities across all business units. The platform embodies our commitment to operational efficiency, accountability, and a unified brand experience.

In Phase 1, the system was successfully rolled out to staff across the bank – KE Market, enabling merchandise requests through a digitized process that has improved coordination and visibility across departments.

Following the rollout, valuable **user feedback** was collected highlighting key opportunities to enhance functionality, simplify workflows, and elevate the overall user experience.

4.2 Next Steps

As part of our broader Digital at the Core strategy, we propose embarking on **Phase 2 – the Enhancement Project**. This phase will focus on:

- Improving **user interface and experience** for greater ease of use and adoption.
- Enhancing the **automation and analytics** to enable real-time tracking and reporting.
- Elevating the **system integration** with existing platforms to ensure end-to-end consistency.
- Enhancing **governance, accountability, and compliance** through improved reporting capabilities.

Key Business Objectives

- Implement a centralized merchandise management system to consolidate all bank merchandise under one unified platform, enhancing visibility, accountability, and control across all Business Units.
- Establish a centralized staff merchandise tracking mechanism to ensure transparency, efficient allocation, and proper utilization of bank branded collateral.

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- Optimize the merchandise request and approval workflow to improve efficiency, responsiveness, and stakeholder satisfaction across departments.

4.3 Strategic Alignment to REA Transformation Agenda

This represents a significant operational efficiency gain and directly supports the Bank's Reduce | Eliminate | Automate (REA) transformation agenda by removing manual workload, standardizing governance, and enabling scalable merchandise management.

Operational Efficiency

- Elimination of email-based request handling
- Structured workflow automation
- Centralized inventory visibility

Governance & Compliance

- Approval-based request workflows
- Audit trails for all merchandise transactions
- Controlled access through role-based permissions

Data Visibility

- Real-time reporting through Power BI
- Department-level merchandise usage insights
- Consolidation of learning hours from multiple sources

4.4 Process key contact

This document was built based on the inputs provided by the Process Subject Matter Expert (SME)/ Process Owner. The Process Owner is expected to review it and provide signoff for accuracy and completion of the steps, context, impact, and complete set of process exceptions.

Role	Name	Notes
Process SMEs	Abigael Opondo	SME Experts
Process Developer	Victor Ngeno	Power App Dev
Process Architect	Wilson Wandu	SA, BI Dev & Documentation
Process Owner	Charles Ndirangu	Senior Brand Manager

4.5 Minimum Pre-requisites for Development

- Completed and approved Business Requirements Document (BRD)
- Accurate baseline merchandise data (inventory, costs, product details).
- Defined user access levels (User, Approver, Administrator)

4.6 Applications used in the AS-IS process

List of applications used in the As-is process:

Application Name	Version	System Language	Environment	Access Method	Comments
Excel	2013+	EN	Local desktop	Manual	Used for formatting and macros
Merchandise Hub	Version 1	EN	MS Power App	Secured Access	Improving this version
Email (Outlook)	n/a	EN	Microsoft 365	Web Portal	Used for sharing and communication

5 Process General Overview

5.1 Process Purpose

The Merchandise Hub Management Process enables departments across NCBA to request, approve, allocate, and track branded merchandise through a centralized digital platform.

#	Item	Description
1	Department Name	Marketing, Communications & Citizenship
2	Process Name	Merchandise Hub Management Process
3	Process Area	Merchandise Request & Inventory Management
4	Short Description	Digital process for requesting, approving, and distributing branded merchandise
5	Role Performing Process	Staff Requestors, Line Managers, MCC Business Partners, Store Managers, System Administrators
6	Process Schedule	Year-round
7	Process Frequency	Event-driven
8	Average handling time per item	2 hours Daily
9	Input data	Merchandise request details
10	Output data	Approved requests, inventory updates, reports

5.2 Value Case

The transition from a fragmented, email-based coordination model to a centralized digital ecosystem is designed to solve for Structural Integrity in the following ways:

#	Item	Baseline (before implementation)	Expected Benefits																
1	Faster TAT (Man-Hours Reduction)	Computation of working days in a year:<table><tr><td>Number of days in year</td><td>365</td></tr><tr><td>Number of weeks in a year</td><td>52</td></tr><tr><td>Weekends Off</td><td>104</td></tr><tr><td>Total working Days</td><td>261</td></tr></table> <table><tr><th>Subgroup</th><th>Estimated Annual Hours Saved</th></tr><tr><td>Main bank</td><td>1248</td></tr><tr><td>NCBAIG</td><td>604</td></tr><tr><td>Loop</td><td>416</td></tr></table> Annual Man-Hour Savings = 2, 268 hours	Number of days in year	365	Number of weeks in a year	52	Weekends Off	104	Total working Days	261	Subgroup	Estimated Annual Hours Saved	Main bank	1248	NCBAIG	604	Loop	416	- Automated workflow execution reduces processing time to 1–5 minutes per request batch >99% reduction in processing time - Significant reduction in manual intervention across all roles 2,268 hours reclaimed annually -equivalent to 287 working days across all three entities
Number of days in year	365																		
Number of weeks in a year	52																		
Weekends Off	104																		
Total working Days	261																		
Subgroup	Estimated Annual Hours Saved																		
Main bank	1248																		
NCBAIG	604																		
Loop	416																		
2	Governance & Approval Control	- Approval workflows inconsistently applied - Manual processes allow bypassing of approval hierarchy	100% enforced approval workflow compliance - Automated routing ensures all requests follow defined hierarchy - Complete audit trail for every transaction																

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3	Data Visibility & Reporting	• Fragmented data across email, Excel, and manual tracking • Limited visibility into inventory and request status	• Centralized data repository (Power Apps + BI integration) • Real-time reporting with near 100% visibility of requests and inventory • Improved decision-making through analytics and dashboards
4	Risk Mitigation & Compliance	• Risk of distributing non-compliant or unapproved merchandise • Limited control over brand governance	• 100% brand compliance enforcement through system controls • Reduced risk of reputational damage • Automated validation and approval checkpoints
5	Inventory Control & Accountability	• Untracked or poorly tracked inventory movements • Limited accountability across business units	• Full inventory traceability across lifecycle (request → approval → dispatch) • Improved stock accuracy (target ≥ 98%) • Accountability enforced through role-based actions

6	Institutional Knowledge & Continuity	Heavy reliance on individual knowledge and manual coordination	- Standardized and system-driven process logic - Reduced dependency on individuals - Improved continuity and scalability of operations
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5.3 Success Measures / Key Performance Indicators

The success of the Merchandise Hub should therefore be evaluated based on **process governance, visibility, and adoption metrics**, rather than purely time-based efficiency measures. The following KPIs are recommended to assess the effectiveness of the solution:

#	KPI	Target	Comment
1	Process Adoption Rate	95% in Yr 1 and 100% by Yr 2.	The organization to fully migrate from informal request channels to the structured process.
2	Inventory Visibility Accuracy	≥ 98% inventory accuracy.	Ensures the system provides reliable data for planning and governance.
3	Request Processing Turnaround Time	48 – 72 hours for standard requests.	Average time taken from request submission to final approval.
4	Merchandise Utilization Visibility	100%	100% reporting visibility through the Power BI dashboard.

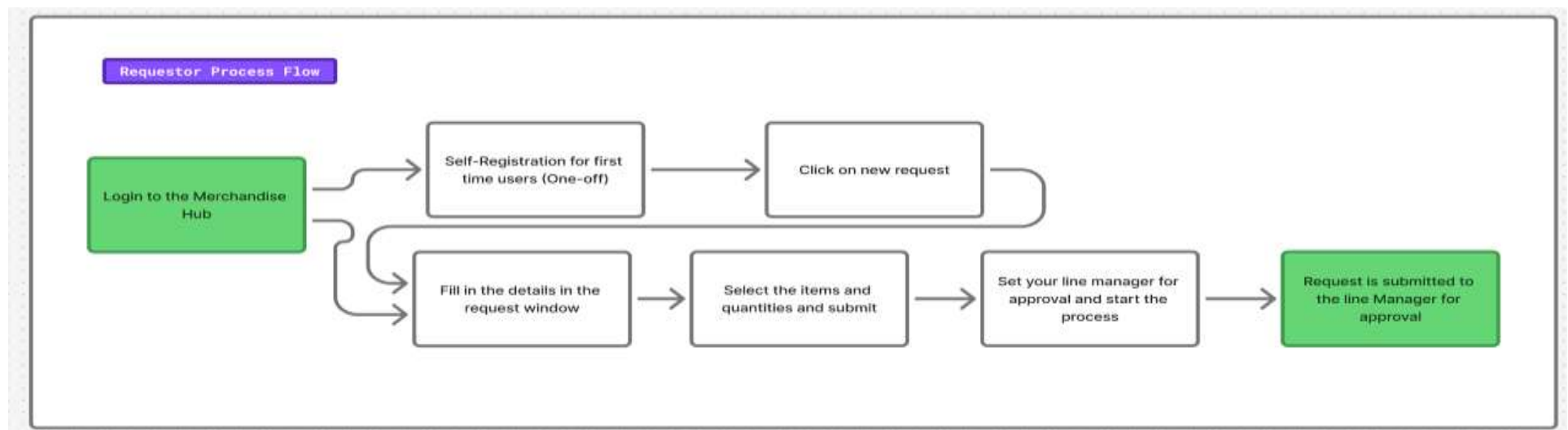
5.4 Process Scope

In/out of scope	Scope description
In scope	• Merchandise request submission • Approval workflows • Inventory allocation and stock tracking • Merchandise dispatch and confirmation • System reporting and analytics
Out of Scope	• Vendor procurement processes • Merchandise production • Financial procurement approvals

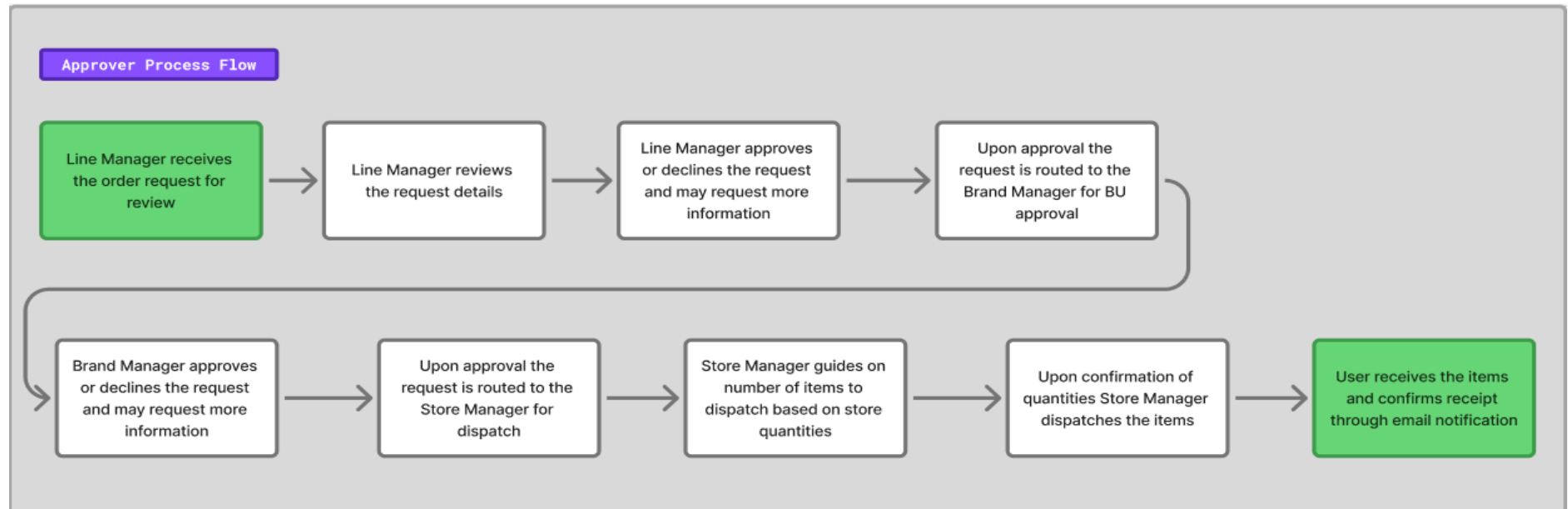
6 AS-IS Process Overview

This section depicts the As-Is business process in detail to enable the developer to build the automated process.

<https://www.figma.com/board/MP4LThaSFxmLuBec3gtLS/Merchandise-Hub-Request-Process?node-id=0-1&t=aWyZzwfdHNMJtasT-1>



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#	Steps	Description of Key Process Steps
1	User Accesses the Merchandise Hub	The user logs into the Merchandise Hub system to initiate a merchandise request.
2	First-Time User Registration (If Required)	If the user is accessing the system for the first time, they complete a one-time self-registration process to gain access to the platform.
3	Initiate New Request	The user selects the "New Request" option to begin creating a merchandise request.
4	Enter Request Details	The user fills in the required details in the request window, including relevant request information.

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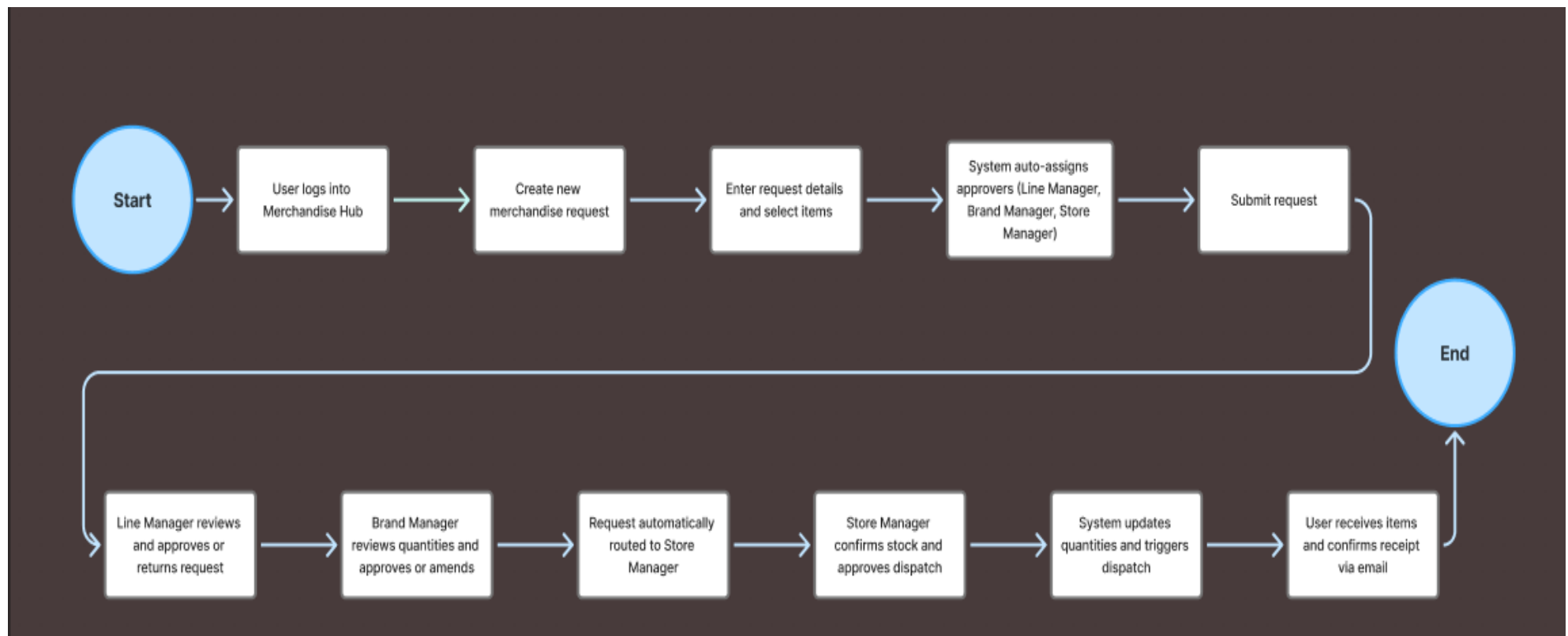
5	Select Items and Quantities	The user selects the required merchandise items and specifies the quantities needed before submitting the request.
6	Assign Line Manager for Approval	The user identifies and selects their Line Manager within the system to route the request for approval and starts the approval workflow.
7	Line Manager Reviews Request	The Line Manager reviews the submitted request details to determine whether the request is valid and aligned with requirements.
8	Route Request to Brand Manager	If approved by the Line Manager, the request is automatically routed to the Brand Manager for Business Unit approval.
9	Brand Manager Decision	The Brand Manager may approve, decline, or request additional information before the request proceeds.
10	Route Request to Store Manager	Once approved by the Brand Manager, the request is routed to the Store Manager for fulfilment and dispatch.
11	Stock Availability Review	The Store Manager reviews store inventory and advises on the number of items that can be dispatched based on available stock levels.
12	Dispatch Items	Upon confirmation of available quantities, the Store Manager prepares and dispatches the requested merchandise items.

7 TO-BE Process Overview

7.1 Process Diagram

This section depicts the To-Be business process in detail to enable the developer to build the automated process.

<https://www.figma.com/board/Lf9SWwXrLpm2YD9nvysHbi/To-Be-Merchandise-Request-Process?node-id=0-1&t=g25Hqo3hVivMo3o9-1>



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Below is a legend of the process steps and symbols presented in the TO-BE Diagram above:

Legend	
	This process step is proposed for automation
	This process step remains manual (to be performed by human agent)
	Change/ Improvement opportunity
	Area or Branch Already Automated

7.2 TO-BE Process Steps

The table below provides a short description of the process steps presented in the TO-BE Process Map:

	Steps	Description of key process steps
1	Access Merchandise Hub	The requester logs into the Merchandise Hub to initiate the merchandise request process.
2	Complete First-Time Registration	Where the requester is a first-time user, they complete the one-off self-registration process before accessing the request's functionality.
3	Create New Request	The requester clicks on New Request to start raising a merchandise request in the system.
4	Select Items and Quantities	The requester selects the required merchandise items and indicates the quantities needed for approval.
5	Define Approval Route	The requester selects their Line Manager as the first approver in the system.
6	Automated Approval Routing	The system automatically assigns the MCC/Brand Manager as the second approver and includes the Store Manager as the fulfilment stage in the workflow.

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7	Line Manager Review	The Line Manager reviews the request details and either approves , declines , or returns the request for clarification.
8	MCC / Brand Manager Review	Once approved by the Line Manager, the request is automatically routed to the MCC / Brand Manager for approval. The approver may approve , decline , amend quantities , or request clarification .
9	Dispatch Approval	The Store Manager reviews the approved request and confirms it for dispatch based on available stock.

7.3 Input and output data

Input/Output	Data name	System	Data validation (Y/N)
Input	- Merchandise request details - Merchandise inventory data - Approval decisions	Power App	Yes
Output	- Approved merchandise requests - Inventory updates - Utilization reports - Dashboard analytics	Power BI, Power App, RPA bot	Yes

8 Business Exceptions Handling (Include Exception Table)

Document how the bot will handle the exceptions noted in section 5

Exception ID	Exception Name	Where it occurs	Action to Be Executed
1	Requested Quantity Exceeds Unit Balance	Checkout/request submission	Block checkout; prompt requester to adjust quantity
2	Line Manager Returns Request	Approval step	Notify requester via email with return comments; request remains editable; audit trail entry created
3	Line Manager / Brand Manager / Store Manager Rejects Request	Approval step	Close request; store rejection reason; notify requester via email; record decision in Approvals table
4	Stock Depleted at Checkout	Request submission	Block submission; display out-of-stock message; notify Brand Manager / Store Manager to restock

9 Reporting Requirements

This section outlines the reporting, monitoring, and analytics requirements for the Merchandise Hub Power App. The platform will support operational reporting, inventory governance, and management visibility through an integrated Business Intelligence (BI) layer.

#	Report Type	Frequency	Details	Audience	Monitoring Tool
1	Request Status Tracker	Real-Time	All active requests by status — Pending, Approved, Returned, Rejected — filterable by unit and requester	Requesters, Line Managers	Power App Dashboard
2	Approval Queue Summary	Real-Time	Requests awaiting action per approver (Line Manager, Brand Manager, Store Manager); average turnaround time	Brand Managers, Store Managers	Power App Admin View
3	Inventory Balance Report	Real-Time	Current stock levels per SKU, allocated quantity per unit vs. current balance; low-stock flags	Brand Managers, Store Managers	Power App Dashboard
4	Merchandise Requests by Department	Real-Time	Volume of requests per unit/department; breakdown by item category and approval outcome	Brand Managers, Store Managers	Power BI
5	Executive Merchandise KPI Dashboard	Real-Time	Total items issued, total allocation value consumed, top-requested SKUs, approval SLA compliance	Brand Managers, Store Managers, MCC Heads	Power BI